The "exorcism" you are referring to was likely the **Autumnal Equinox ritual** Kenneth Anger performed at the Straight Theater in San Francisco's Haight-Ashbury on September 21, 1967.

In the occult community, this was viewed as a high-stakes ceremony intended to conjure the Egyptian deity Horus and officially launch the "New Age."

The Ritual: "Equinox of the Gods":

- **The Intent:** Anger titled the event "The Equinox of the Gods," a reference to Aleister Crowley's announcement of a new spiritual era. To Anger, it was a theatrical ceremony to initiate the local "flower children" into the mysteries of the Ordo Templi Orientis (O.T.O.).
- **The Performance:** A be-robed Anger prowled the stage like a "mystic lion," performing before an altar he designed. He set things on fire, waved a swastika flag (as a symbol of the "Whirling Force" rather than political affiliation), and reportedly commanded the audience into "convulsions."
- **The Sound: Bobby Beausoleil** provided the "sonic backdrop," improvising on an amplified bouzouki to create an "exotic, futuristic din" that was meant to vibrate the theater into a different dimension.

Connection to *Invocation of My Demon Brother*:
The Straight Theater ritual was filmed and incorporated into Anger's 1969 short, **Invocation of My Demon Brother**.

- **Cinematic Exorcism:** In the film, this footage is played at an exaggerated, frenzied speed. This editing style was Anger's way of performing an "attack on the sensorium," essentially **exorcising the viewer** of their traditional logic and forcing them into a state of "magical awareness."
- **The "Shadow" Era:** Because the film was released shortly after the Manson murders, the sight of a Manson follower (Beausoleil) on screen during these rituals gave the "exorcism" a much darker, literal meaning to the public.

Why it felt like an Exorcism:
Contemporaries described the event as a psyche-searing experience. By bringing these "darker" occult elements into the center of the hippie movement; Anger was essentially trying to "exorcise" the naive, peaceful surface of the Summer of Love to reveal the raw, pagan power he believed lay underneath.

Would you like to know more about the **poster art** for the event or the other **psychedelic bands** that shared the stage with Anger that night?